CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem moves from a particular incident to a: 1

(a) history of a port **(b)** description of a city
(c) general reflection on loss **(d)** story of a game

2. The watching poet's detachment shows: 1

(a) respect for the boy's privacy **(b)** fear
(c) lack of care **(d)** boredom

3. Choose the correct passive: 'The boy lost the ball.' 1

(a) The boy was lost. **(b)** The ball was lost by the boy.
(c) The ball loses the boy. **(d)** The ball lost the boy.

4. The poet refuses to say 'there are other balls' because: 1

(a) the boy needs to grieve **(b)** the poet is poor
(c) balls are rare **(d)** the poet is angry

5. The poem's central image is: 1

(a) a ball in a shop **(b)** a harbour fair
(c) a boy staring at water **(d)** a birthday cake

6. The adverb in 'He stood silently' is: 1

(a) silently **(b)** stood **(c)** there **(d)** he

7. The phrase 'shaking grief' suggests: 1

(a) intense emotion **(b)** a mild mood **(c)** a game **(d)** an earthquake

8. The poem's last lines are about: 1

(a) learning to stand up after loss **(b)** playing
(c) buying a ball **(d)** swimming

9. 'Console' means: 1

(a) praise **(b)** comfort **(c)** scold **(d)** ignore

10. The poem suggests that grief teaches: 1

(a) trade **(b)** speed **(c)** greed **(d)** responsibility

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why does the poet describe the ball as bouncing merrily? 2

12. Why does the poet refuse to intrude? 2

13. What does the poet mean by learning to 'stand up'? 2

14. What is the effect of the rhetorical questions in the poem? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse the contrast in the opening lines of the poem. 3

16. Explain the line about the 'world of possessions'. 3

17. Rewrite in indirect speech: The poet said, 'Money cannot buy back his grief.' 3

OR

Discuss the significance of the poet's refusal to give money. 3

18. What does the poem imply about adults who say 'there are other balls'? 3

OR

Combine: 'The boy lost his ball. He stood by the water.' 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Analyse how John Berryman develops the theme of loss in 'The Ball Poem'. 5

OR

Write a speech on 'Materialism vs real values' referring to the poem. 5

20. Discuss the poet's attitude to the boy and to consolation. 5

OR

Describe the poem's movement from narration to reflection. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND